

SoulSpeak Project Documentation

A 7 Cups-inspired mental wellness and peer-support platform for guided onboarding, community discussion, trained listener matching, real-time chat, reports, and admin moderation.

Layer	Current implementation
Frontend	React 18 + Vite, React Router, Tailwind CSS, lucide-react icons, axios, Socket.IO client, jsPDF for
Backend	Express 4, MongoDB/Mongoose, JWT authentication, bcrypt password hashing, multer uploads, n
Data	Users, profile pictures, posts, reports, companion-test questions, chats/messages. Uploaded imag
Runtime	Backend defaults to PORT from .env or 5001, while frontend API calls currently target http://localh

Existing Features

- ? **Public landing experience:** home page with SoulSpeak introduction and fetched daily advice quote.
- ? **Authentication:** signup, login, JWT persistence in localStorage, logout, password reset request, reset token confirmation.
- ? **Guided onboarding:** multi-step signup collects referral source, mental health condition, age group, gender, country, goals, preferences, and account details.
- ? **Profile management:** protected profile page, editable personal fields, password change, email verification request, profile image upload and preview.
- ? **Companion path:** users can take a companion assessment from admin-created questions; a score of 70% or above marks the user as a companion.
- ? **Training program:** companion-learning page shows assessment topics and resource links from the question bank.
- ? **Community forum:** create posts by category, attach images, edit/delete own posts, upvote, comment, delete own comments, filter category feeds, and access wellness-resource links.
- ? **Real-time chat:** users can browse available companions, create one-to-one chats, send messages, receive Socket.IO updates, and view chat history.
- ? **Reporting:** users can file reviews, profile reports, and chat reports, then track status.
- ? **Admin console:** manage companion-test questions, view users and roles, review reports, update report status with email notification, export report summaries to PDF, suspend or activate accounts.
- ? **Media uploads:** post images and profile pictures are stored through multer and served statically from the uploads directory.

Primary User Flows

- ? **New member:** lands on home, signs up through the wellness intake, logs in, verifies email, completes profile, joins forum, or starts chat with a companion.
- ? **Future companion:** opens Become A Companion, completes assessment, becomes a companion automatically at 70%+, otherwise receives training-program direction.
- ? **Companion/listener:** appears in the companion directory and can participate in direct chats.
- ? **Community member:** creates categorized posts, uploads images, comments, upvotes, and reports problematic profiles or chats.
- ? **Admin:** maintains assessment content, monitors users/reports, exports PDFs, and handles suspensions.

API Surface

Area	Routes
Auth/Profile	POST /signup, POST /login, GET/PUT /profile, POST /verify-email, GET /confirm-email, POST /reset-password, POST /confirm
Forum	GET/POST /posts, PUT/DELETE /posts/:id, POST /posts/:id/upvote, POST /posts/:id/comments, GET /posts/:id/comments, D
Companion	POST /companion, GET /companions, GET /questions
Reports	GET/POST /reports, PATCH /admin/reports/:id/status
Admin	GET/POST /admin/questions, PUT/DELETE /admin/questions/:id, GET /admin/users, POST /admin/suspend, POST /admin/a
Chat	GET /chat, POST /chat/create, POST /chat/send, Socket.IO newChat/newMessage/join events

Features To Be Added In This UI Upgrade

- ? **Modern 7 Cups-inspired home:** full-width emotional-support hero, trust metrics, service cards, member journey, safety/availability panels, daily advice, and stronger calls to action.
- ? **Responsive navigation:** sticky glass-style header, mobile menu, role-aware actions, clearer logged-in and logged-out pathways.
- ? **Wellness-first visual system:** calmer color tokens, improved typography, consistent buttons, panels, form fields, status badges, and soft surfaces.
- ? **Improved onboarding:** clearer progress indicator, modern choice cards, contextual helper copy, and a friendlier account-creation finish.
- ? **Modern auth screens:** split support-oriented layout, stronger reset-password modal, better error/success states, and accessible focus styling.
- ? **Profile dashboard feel:** avatar upload polish, verification status, member details, edit states, and structured wellness preferences.
- ? **Community refinements:** cleaner composer, category chips, resource sidebar, feed cards, image previews, and interaction controls.
- ? **Chat polish:** calmer two-column messenger layout, companion discovery panel, message bubbles, empty states, and typing/status-ready affordances.
- ? **Admin/report readability:** dashboard-style surfaces, tabs, tables, status chips, export actions, and moderation controls.
- ? **Responsive polish:** layouts should fit desktop and mobile without overflow, overlapping text, or cramped controls.

Known Risks And Technical Notes

- ? Frontend API calls point to port 5000; backend index uses process.env.PORT or 5001. The .env file should keep these aligned for local testing.
- ? Admin authorization is currently email-based with admin@gmail.com in controller logic; a formal role field would be safer for production.
- ? Socket typing events are emitted by the frontend but the socket server currently does not broadcast typing/stopTyping events.
- ? Multer validates image MIME type but file size limits and image cleanup are not implemented.
- ? Question option fields are arrays in the schema while some admin form values are plain strings; current UI reads option1[0], option2[0], etc.
- ? No automated tests are present; verification should include build, smoke navigation, and manual API-backed flows.

Suggested Future Roadmap

- ? Add crisis resources and safety escalation copy for high-risk mental health contexts.
- ? Introduce listener availability, specialties, ratings, and matching filters.
- ? Add notifications for new messages, report updates, and companion approval milestones.
- ? Add mood tracking with private trends and optional journal entries.
- ? Add moderation queues, content flags, audit logs, and richer admin analytics.
- ? Move API base URL into a frontend environment variable and add integration tests for core flows.

Generated for the SoulSpeak workspace after reading the existing frontend, backend routes, controllers, models, and Socket.IO implementation.